DEBRE MEHRET MEDHANE ALEM ETHIOPIAN ORTHODOX TEWAHEDO CHURCH

BY-LAWS

Date: February 20, 2011



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ARTICLE ONE: GENERAL

1.1 TITLE

The by-laws and the constitution enclosed herein may be referred to as, "The By-laws and Constitution of the Debre Mehret Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church" in the Peidmont Triad and the surrounding areas.

1.2 NAME

The name of this organization shall be "DEBRE MEHRET MEDHANE ALEM ETHIOPIAN ORTHODOX TEWAHEDO CHURCH" and may be referred to in this document as "Medhane Alem Church"; "The Parish"; or "MAEOTC".

1.3 PRINCIPAL OFFICE

Debre Mehret Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church will have the following addresses:-

Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church

4301 Chilton Way
High point, NC 27265

1.4 CORPORATE SEAL

The corporate seal of MAEOTC shall be a circular disk in form and shall bear a distinctive cross and the full name of the Church in both Amharic and English versions inscribed on it. The seal shall be used only by an authorized officer of the Church for the validation of official written communications with individuals as well as organizations in matters that only relate to the Church.

1.5 FISCAL YEAR

The Church's fiscal year will be from January 1 through December 31.

ARTICLE TWO: LEGAL STATUS

2.1 INCORPORATION

Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church acquired its legal status through its incorporation filed with the North Carolina Secretary of State in March 24, 2011.

2.2 OWNERSHIP

As per Chapter 55A, Article 2 of North Carolina General Assembly's General Statutes, post incorporation, the ownership rights to the Church are vested only to those Registered Members as validated by the Membership List of the Church.



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2.3 TAX-EXEMPT STATUS

MAEOTC is organized exclusively for religious purpose within the confines of Section 501(c)(3) the United States Internal Revenue Service code thus making it exempt from federal income tax obligations and allowing personal or corporate contributions to the Church to be tax-deductible under Section 170(c)(2) of the same code. Similarly, the Church will obtain its tax-exempt status from the North Carolina Department of Revenue.

ARTICLE THREE: CHURCH GOVERNANCE

3.1 INCORPORATION

As referenced in Article 2.3 above, as a condition of the Church's tax-exempt status, the Church will only engage in allowable religious, cultural, educational and social activities. Accordingly, Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church (MAEOTC) will strictly prohibit any individual or group from undertaking any activity that falls outside of this mandate on the Church's behalf.

3.2 CHURCH ADMINISTRATION

MAEOTC follows the Ethiopian Orthodox faith, and all related creeds, teachings, and religious traditions, under the guiadance of His Holiness Patriarch Abune Merkorios and The Holy Synod in North America.

3.3 CHURCH LEADERSHIP

The Registered Members of MAEOTC will possess ultimate authority over all aspects of the Church's operation. The day-to-day management of the Church affairs will be the responsibility of an elected Parish Council comprised of 8 members and the Head Priest. This body will be accountable to the Registered Members of the Church.

3.4 COMPLIANCE WITH LAWS

The Parish Council will follow the by-laws herein as well as the applicable federal, state, and local laws in carrying out its leadership of the Parish.

3.5 NON-ALIGNMENT DISCRIMINATION

MAEOTC will operate free from any alignment or influence from any and all political organizations; and will not condone any ethnicism, tribalism and racism.

ARTICLE FOUR: CHURCH PURPOSE AND MISSION

4.1 PURPOSE

4.1.1 To preserve the Holy Orthodox faith and ensure the continuity of its service.



4.1.2 To encourage those in service of the Church and provide them support in their discipleship of our Lord.

4.1.3 To enable the many Ethiopians in the Diaspora to practice the EOTC faith and serve as a base of community as well as introduce same to those Ethiopians who may not have the familiarity or knowledge.

4.1.4 To increase the number of the faithful and to provide spiritual education to enable them to grow and become stronger in their understanding of the Scriptures and in their Christian deeds.

4.1.5 To promote peace and harmony among Churches and between Members of the Parish as well as the General Parishioners.

4.1.6 To coordinate as able, charitable assistance to victims of starvation and natural disasters and dislocation in Ethiopia.

4.1.7 While keeping with Article 3.2 above, the Church shall maintain relations with other similar Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Churches and other religious and charitable organizations.

4.2 MISSION/DUTIES

4.2.1 To preach the Gospel of our Lord and to further His Kingdom on Earth.

4.2.2 To conduct services of divine worship and religious services in accordance with our Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo teachings and traditions, including those of Baptism/Christening; Marriage Counseling and Wedding Ceremonies; liturgical rites for the dying or the dead ("Fithat"); reconciliation; and other counseling.

4.2.3 To organize and ensure the functioning of biblical study groups and various committees of goodwill and Christian love, and providing operating frameworks for said groups and committees and monitoring their progress, providing assistance where needed.

4.2.4 Organize various education programs to help build on the parishioners' knowledge of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church, its history, traditions, holy icons and writings.

4.2.5 To develop activities and programs to help our youth to resist harmful behavior and character that is counter to our Orthodox beliefs and standards.

4.2.6 To organize and carry out children's educational curriculum based on Christian love and harmony through collaboration between concerned parents and members of the Parish Council to help our children grow in their knowledge of their faith, history, culture, values, languages and to recognize their accomplishments in this regard through appreciation events and programs.

4.2.7 While keeping with Article 3.2 above, the church shall maintain relations with other churches and other religious and charitable organizations.

4.2.8 To prepare and maintain various statistical records, logs, and documents with respect to the religious church activities that can be presented as a report when needed.

ARTICLE FIVE: MEMBERSHIP: RIGHTS AND DUTIES

5.1 MEMBERSHIP

Without limitation to age, any individual member of a household who believes that our Lord Jesus Christ is the Savior and has been baptized into the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church will have the right to be registered as a Member of Medhane Alem Church. Any such Member who is 18 years or older and meets the following criteria will be eligible to exercise an additional right to vote on Church matters requiring a vote:

5.1.1 Unless extenuating circumstances dictate, frequently attends Church services and diligently works to promote the mission of MAEOTC;

5.1.2 Contributes financially to support the services of the Church according to his/her means;

5.1.3 Complies with these by-laws and related directives;

5.1.4 Each Member of the Church will be issued with a Membership card with a unique Membership identification number. Each Member will be required to renew his or her Membership card annually.

5.2 RIGHTS

5.2.1 To the extent that a Registered Member has maintained valid Membership over the preceding 12 months before elections for Parish Council or Audit Committee, such a Member shall be eligible for election to said officer roles.

5.2.2 Any Registered Member of the Church will have the right to vote for any Church Officers and Inspections Committee Members.

5.2.3 Any Registered Member of the Church will have the right to participate in discussions presented at general Membership meetings on any topic and to freely offer their perspective and vote on such matters, as required.

5.2.4 Any Registered Member will have the right to be informed about the financial and property records of the Church, upon presenting the appropriate request to the Parish Council.

5.2.5 Any Parish Member seeking to participate in the Holy Liturgy and/or to receive the Sacraments of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church will have the right to do so with no payment.

5.2.6 Parents who are Members will be able to have their children participate in youth educational programs organized by the Church.

5.2.7 As per the rules set by the Church Officers, non-registered members will have Church services, such as baptism, marriage..etc with payments

5.3 DUTIES

5.3.1 Unless extenuating circumstances dictate, Registered Members are expected to fulfill the financial obligations they agreed to.

5.3.2 Although all functions and roles within the Church are voluntary in nature, Members are expected to show their support and participation of Church activities when requested.

5.3.3 Each Member will have the duty to accept these by-laws of the Church and to be bound by all provision contained herein.

5.3.4 When on Church property, each Member is strictly prohibited from initiating on taking part in any disruptive or divisive action or language that adversely affects the unity and cohesion of the Church's community. However, a member has the right to offer his/her perspective and participate freely in discussions during general Church meetings.

5.4 TERMINATION OF AND REINSTATEMENT TO MEMBERSHIP

5.4.1 If a Registered Member engages in misconduct or immoral behavior or in behavior that is counter to the precepts and teachings of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church or if the Registered Member fails to provide an acceptable explanation for not fulfilling his/her financial obligation to the Church after being asked to bring their financial obligation current:

a) He or she shall be counseled by a Member who is close to him/her;

b) If he or she does not address the issue appropriately, will then be warned by two Members of the Parish Council;

c) Finally, will be counseled by the Church Priest, based on the religious teachings of our Orthodox faith.

If the Member does not correct the behavior or address the financial obligation in question after all of the above counseling, warnings, and reprimands, the Executive Committee of the Parish Council will terminate the individual from the Membership Register of the Church and will lose all rights and privileges of Registered Membership.

5.4.2 Any individual who is terminated from the Membership Register of the Church will retain the right to worship in the Church and participate in Holy Liturgy and receive Holy Sacraments, as long as he or she has not undergone a change to their faith.

5.4.3 If a Member who has been terminated from the Membership Register demonstrates remorse for his or her actions and shows that he or she has corrected the violation and has an interest in being reinstated as a Registered Member, he or she must submit their application for reinstatement in

writing to the Parish Council. Application for reinstatement may be based on the proof of the individual's remorse and their correction of the violation in question.

ARTICLE SIX: ROLE OF THE CLERGY

6.1 The clergy section will administer all religious functions and will allocate all clergy in various areas of service, as appropriate.

6.2 While tenure will be an important consideration in determining the clergy hierarchy, additional considerations will be given to experience and qualifications.

6.3 The clergy section will ensure that only ordained priests, deacons or monks serve as part of the Church's clergy.

6.4 In the event of a shortfall of available clergy to conduct necessary services or rites the clergy section of the Church will assist in the evaluation of the credentials of prospective additions to the Church clergy and provide its assessment, along with any recommendations to the Parish Council.

6.5 The final decision on the hiring or termination of clergy will be the Church's Parish Council.

6.6 The clergy will perform rites and administer Sacraments, such as baptism/Christening, rites for the dead or dying, marriage ceremonies, and memorial prayers and services for all parishioners, in accordance with the tenets of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church.

6.7 The clergy will ensure that all religious services, including the Holy Liturgy and all other spiritual services are conducted in accordance with tenets of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church.

6.8 The clergy section will be responsible to organize, guide and follow-up Sunday School activities. In collaboration with the appropriate parties, will plan and implement curricula for the youth.

6.9 The clergy will consult with the Parish Council before inviting guest clergy and church fathers to attend the celebration of Church feasts.

6.10 When invited to attend other churches' feasts, members of the clergy will first consult with the Parish Council in order to appoint the appropriate representative members of the clergy to attend those events.

6.11 The clergy section ensures that all members of the clergy are present for all required services where they render their services and that they fulfill their duties to the Parish.

6.12 If the member of the clergy displays a lack of discipline or is deemed to not be fulfilling his responsibilities, he will first be reprimanded verbally and then in writing by the clergy section. If the clergy continues the character in question, the Parish Council will take appropriate action.

6.13 If any member of the clergy voluntarily plans to leaves his position, he has to provide to the Parish Council in writing at least a three-month in advance.

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6.14 The clergy section will provide its annual budget to the Parish Council for aproval.

ARTICLE SEVEN: THE ROLES AND THE RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE HEAD CLERGY

The Church activities will be more fruitful and effective when there is collaboration among the various parties (The Clergy, the Parish Council, the Inspection Committee, other committees and the Church Members. The Head Priest/Clergy who is a member of the Parish Council and also head of the Spiritual matters will have the following responsibilities.

7.1 The senior member of the clergy who is elected by the clergy section as the Head Clergy, will be the leader of the Church's clergy and also the overall leader of all spiritual matters.

7.2 The Head Clergy will be an appropriately ordained priest and will have the responsibilities enumerated below:

7.3 Will have ultimate responsibility to ensure that the clergical duties listed in Article 6, numbers 6.1 to 6.14, above have been carried out as required.

7.4 Will provide overall leadership for religious education programs for children, youth, and adults, ensuring that these programs have developed appropriate curricula and rules of conduct.

7.5 May himself or through a delegate, provide invocation and appropriate spiritual counseling at meetings of the Parish Council and the General Parish Members.

7.6 Ensures that all spiritual services conducted in the Church are in full accordance with the faith and order of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church and that they in no way in an implied or expressed for disruptive to the peace and harmony of the Parish and its Members.

7.7 Assures that the Parish membership continues to grow over time, mobilizes the clergy, Church leadership, and parishioners to take part in various Church activities and programs by taking a leadership role. Accordingly, carries on the Church's pastoral duties, such as visiting the sick, creating reconciliation among those in disputes, counseling the grieving, encouraging the return of Members who may have strayed from or left the Church, aid those in need, and playing a key role in fostering and maintaining true Christian love and harmony between Members. The Head Clergy will be expected to demonstrate exemplary leadership in this most important respect.

7.8 Will be responsible for signing certificates of baptism/Christening, marriage, and any certificates of appreciation for participation in various Church activities and on letters of invitation to attend Church feasts.

7.9 So long as it is in keeping with the provisions of these by-laws, may represent the Church on religious matters.

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ARTICLE EIGHT: THE PARISH COUNCIL

8.1 SELECTION/FORMATION

8.1.1 The Parish Council of Debre Mehret Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church will provide overall leadership of the Church, except for Canonical matters, responsible for the stewardship of all Church-owned property and resources.

8.1.2 The membership of the Parish Council will be in accordance with Article Three, number 3.3 above.

8.1..3 Without regard to gender, any Reregistered Member above the age of 21 who fulfils the criteria listed in Article Five numbers 5.2. and 5.3, of these by-laws and who are affirmed followers of the Orthodox faith, whose good moral standing has been observed by the Members of the Parish, who are willing to offer the sacrifice of their time and talents in service to the Church, and preferably those with a good understanding of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church and its tenets, are eligible to be voted to serve on the Parish Council.

8.1.4 Any member elected as a member of the Parish Council, except the church priest, will not be an employee of the church who earns monetary compensation.

8.1.5 If any member of the Parish Council is unable to fulfill his or her duties due to continued absence caused by a change of address or any other reason, or become a hindrance to the work of the Parish Council, will be replaced by the candidate who earned the highest number of votes during the immediate past election. This decision will then be communicated to the Parish members within two weeks.

8.1.6 The term of the elected members of the Parish Council will be two years. However, a member who is willing to serve for a second term should be nominated and elected to serve for a second term ie. a registered Member is eligible to serve two consecutive terms. In order to be eligible to serve again, a full term (two years) must elapse.

8.2 RESPONSIBLITIES OF THE PARISH COUNCIL

The Parish Council will be accountable to the Registered Members of the Church. Accordingly, in addition to the duties associated with the mission of the Church listed in Article 4.2 above, the Parish Council will be responsible for:

8.2.1 Before commencing their service as a Parish Council, the members will take an oath in the presence of the parishioners of the Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Church to further the mission of the Church as one unified body and will receive the blessings of the clergy on the same occasion.

8.2.2 Based on the Basic Principles of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church and this by-laws, will carry on one's duties and responsibilities.

8.2.3 Striving for sustained harmony, respect and understanding between Members of the Parish and its clergy and that Christian love is pervasive within the Church.

8.2.4 If any disagreements arise between Members of the Parish and the clergy or amongst the ranks of the clergy, takes immediate action to address and resolve the issue. If the matter cannot be resolved with the Parish Council, ensures that it is presented in an orderly manner to the general Membership for discussion and final resolution.

8.2.5 As appropriate, will be responsible for the recruitment and validation of the credentials of paid or unpaid candidates for the clergy of the Church.

8.2.6 Ensures that the financial resources of the Church are maintained in an account or accounts opened in the name of Debre Mehret Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church in a recognized financial institution. Any withdrawals of funds from said account(s) will be made only after two designated Members of the Parish Council approve the withdrawal or payment by their signature and ensures that the expenditures were appropriated correctly.

8.2.7 Reviews all budget submissions from various sections of the Church and approves the annual budget of the Church and communicates the decision, along with the budget to the parishioners for their final approval. Once the budget is adopted, the Parish Council will be accountable for the follow-up of the budget implementation.

8.2.8 Presents an annual report to the Parish at the scheduled General Parish meetings each January.

8.2.9 Ensures that all tangible and intangible assets of the Church have been duly recorded in the name of the Church and its internal records and that they are utilized in a manner acceptable to the Members of the Parish.

8.2.10 Will enter into contractual agreements on behalf of the Church, will act representing the Church in all legal matters, including any litigation.

8.2.11 Serves as a role model to the rest of the parishioners by taking part in celebration of Holy Liturgy and various religious activities and programs.

8.2.12 Ensures that all the activities of the Church are in accordance with its charter, as per the Articles of Incorporation filed with the North Carolina Secretary of State and all applicable federal, state and local statutes.

8.2.13 Implements all actions proposed by the Parish Members, based on and consistent with the provisions of these by-laws.

8.2.14 Based on the different activities of the Church, the Parish Council will form different committees and provides guidelines, allocate necessary budget and carry on necessary supervision activities.

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ARTICLE NINE: ROLES OF THE MEMBERS OF THE PARISH COUNCIL

Upon election by the Registered Members of the Church, the Elected Members of the Parish Council will meet promptly and as first order of business conduct their own election of the following officers: Chair, Vice-Chair, Secretary, Treasurer, Controller, and Public Relations Officer. The six elected members for the specific roles, two extra members and the priest/head priest, nine in total, will be the members of the Parish Council. Within two weeks of the election of these officers, the Parish Council will present the nominations for ratification by the general Membership of the Parish.

The roles of each of the assigned member of the Parish Council is as follows:-

9.1 THE Chair

9.1.1 As chief executive, will preside over all meetings of the General Assembly and the Parish Council.

9.1.2 As chief executive, he is the administrative representative of the Church.

9.1.3 Based on the approved budget, the chair-person of the Parish Council signs documents for the disbursements for the various Church activities.

9.1.4 With the exception of canonical matters, will perform all duties listed in Article Four of these by-laws and any additional ones incident to his/her office and supervises the implementation of these matters.

9.1.5 Will sign all certificates of birth, engagement, and marriage and certificates of appreciation for services rendered to the Church or educational accomplishment, along with the head clergy of the Church.

9.1.6 With the exception of the letters of invitation to other clergy and religious fathers to attend religious church celebration, the Chair will be the signatory on all outgoing letters bearing the official Church letterhead.

9.1.7 Will serve as one of the two signatories on all check disbursements

9.2 VICE CHAIR

9.2.1 Assists the Chair person in various activities of the Church.

9.2.2 In the absence of the Chair, the Vice Chair shall perform all the duties of the Chair, and when so acting shall have all the powers of, and be subject to all the restrictions on, the Chair.

9.2.3 Does Church work when assigned by the Chair Person.

9.2.4 The Vice Chair will carry out any additional duties assigned by the Parish Council.

9.3 SECRETARY

9.3.1 Keeps in an organized fashion, all written, video and audio documents involving the Church and its operations and ensures their safe keeping within the Church offices or other secure location, such as, bank safe deposit box, as appropriate.

9.3.2 Record the minutes of each Parish Council meeting and the general meetings of the Church Members and have each minutes signed by each attending Member of the meeting and keeps all records.safely

9.3.3 Once he/she ensures that all outgoing correspondence has been appropriately signed, disseminates all such correspondence to the addressees.

9.3.4 Ensures that all incoming correspondence to the Church has been appropriately received, logged and presented to the appropriate area for action in a timely manner.

9.3.5 Works with the Chair and Vice Chair to prepare and finalize meeting agendas.

9.3.6 In consultations with the Head Priest, prepares Birth and Baptism Certificates, and other Religious documents and delivers to the concerned.

9.3.7 Will carry out additional duties assigned by the Parish Council Chair Person in accordance with these by-laws.

9.4 TREASURER

9.4.1 The Church Treasurer will be accountable directly to the Parish Council.

9.4.2 Will accept contributions, donations, and other revenues for the Church issuing official receipts to the source of the funding.

9.4.3 Deposits all cash receipts within three business days of receipt into the Church's designated bank account(s).

9.4.4 Ensures that all financial records are maintained in an orderly and organized manner that will be readily auditable.

9.4.5 Issues payments for all Church expenses appropriately recorded in a requisition form.

9.4.6 Disburses specific special expenses approved for the Church services by the Parish Council, as appropriate.

9.4.7 Work with the Controller, prepares the monthly financial statements of the Church and certifies their accuracy.

9.4.8 Accommodates requests from Members of the Parish, the Parish Council, Inspection Committee, Controller, or external accountants and auditors to review the Church financial statements and any supporting documentation.

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9.4.9 Will carry out additional duties assigned by the Parish Council, in accordance with these by-laws.

9.5 CONTROLLER

9.5.1 The Controller will be accountable to the Parish Council of the Church.

9.5.2 Will record all financial transactions in the Church's record reconciling with any records maintained by the Treasurer; presents a monthly financial report to the Parish Council Chair and annually to the Parish Members.

9.5.3 Ensures that all disbursements match with approved requisition forms or directives from the Parish Council as recoded in official minutes of meeting.

9.5.4 Is responsible for completing all required tax filings and documents with the appropriate agencies.

9.5.5 Establishes and follows internal controls that will ensure that Church-owned resources are not misappropriated or mishandled and implements sound accounting procedures.

9.5.6 Ensures that all tangible and intangible assets of the Church have been recorded in the name of the Church and reported to all appropriate external parties.

9.5.7 Will serve as one of two signatories on all check disbursements.

9.5.8 Will carry out additional duties assigned by the Parish Council in accordance with these by-laws.

9.6 PUBLIC RELATIONS OFFICER

The Public Relations Officer will be accountable to the Parish Council and will carry out the following duties.

9.6.1 In accordance with this by-laws, will explain the primary objectives of the Church.

9.6.2 In consultation with the Parish Council, the Clergy (Priest) and other concerned parties, will deliver appropriate messages regarding the activities of the Church to the Parish Members.

9.6.3 Will serve as Chair Person for Church magazine preparation and publication.

9.6.4 Will assist the Parish Council Chair and the Inspection committee the dissemination of information through meetings and/or publication.in line with the bylaws.

ARTICLE TEN: INSPECTIONS COMMITTEE

10.1 The Inspections Committee has three members elected by the Parish Members for a term two years. However, if elected, could serve a second term. The Committee is accountable directly to the Parish Members

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10.2 The Inspection Committee will have its own Chair Person and Secretary and executes its duties independently.

10.3 The Committee inspects the conditions of Church properties, purchased materials and their proper utilization.

10.4 Ensures that financial contributions made for the Church are collected and used as per the guidelines stipulated in the the by-laws.

10.5 Inspects at any reasonable time the books, records, or minutes of proceedings of the members of the Parish Council.

10.6 The Inspections Committee will provide necessary recommendations to the Parish Council and reports annually to the Parish Members regarding various church activities.

10.7 Ensures that Church activities are carried out in line with the by-laws.

10.8 Will coordinate with external accountants and auditors attained by the Church to evaluate the Church's financial statement and offer assurances to their integrity and soundness.

ARTICLE ELEVEN: ELECTIONS COMMITTEE

11.1 The Election Committee has three (3) Members that are elected by the Parish Members. The committee is accountable to the Parish Members.

11.2 Individuals who will be eligible to participate in electing or to be elected as Elections Committee Members will be those who meet the eligibility criteria for Registered Members, as outlined above in Article Five.

11.3 The Elections Committee will elect a Chair person and a secretary to facilitate its work. The Committee's work will culminate with the election of the Parish Council and Inspections Committee.

11.4 The Elections Committee shall design and implement a process to solicit its duties.

11.5 The Committee will use nomination forms to complete the nomination process in two weeks.

11.6 The nominees elected as Members of the Parish Council and Inspections Committee will serve as per the guidelines stipulated in Articles Eight and Ten.

11.7 The votes cast for each nominee will be carefully recorded and retained. In the event that any elected individual leave their elected role voluntarily or otherwise, the nominee with next highest number of votes will be eligible to step into the vacated role.

11.8 Only one Member per family will be eligible to appear on a given nominee slate.

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11.9 All members of Elections Committee will be ineligible to be a nominee for election to Parish Council or Inspections Committee.

11.10 Voting to elect the members of the Parish Council and the Elections Committee is done by secret ballots.

11.11 The handing over of all documents and responsibilities from the previous to the incoming Parish Council and the Inspections Committee members will be facilitated by the Elections Committee.

11.12 The Elections Committee will report the election results to the General Members/Church Parish; and hand over the documents used to the Parish Council.

ARTICLE TWELVE: MEETINGS

12. 1 MEETING SCHEDULES/TIMING

12.1.1 The annual meeting of the General Assembly, defined as all Registered Members whose names are duly recorded and who carry a current and valid Membership card, will be held typically during the month of January on a date and location determined by the Parish Council. However, in cases of emergency, the Parish Council can call for a meeting on a date sooner than the next scheduled annual General Assembly.

12.1.2 The Parish Council shall notify all Registered Members of an upcoming General Assembly meeting including the agenda at least two (2) weeks before the date of the meeting.

11.1.3 The Church Parish Council will meet at least once a month.However, the Committee will meet on a date sooner if required.

12.2 MEETING PROTOCOL/PROCEDURES

The Debre Mehret Medhane Alem Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church business meetings will be conducted with following meeting protocol.

12.2.1 Any assembly shall be opened and concluded with a prayer.

12.2.2 As necessary, attendance of meeting participants will be taken.

12.2.3 51% of the total eligible Membership shall constitute a Quorum, unless otherwise stated in these bylaws.

12.2.4 If a quorum cannot be obtained, the meeting shall be adjourned and rescheduled for a later date; however, if a quorum is still not attained, the meeting will be conducted with the Members present, unless there is a compelling reason to further postpone the meeting. As necessary, the meeting will commence with ratification of the minutes from the previous meeting.

12.2.5 In the event of a tie in a matter that requires a vote, the side of the meeting leader will prevail.

12.2.6 At any meeting, a Member will only be eligible to cast a single vote.

12. 2.7 As necessary, meeting attendees will signify their concurrence with meeting outcomes through their signature.

ARTICLE THIRTEEN: MISCELLANEOUS

13.1 PROPERTY OF MEDHANE ALEM CHURCH

Religious Books (Biblical Scriptures) teach us that a Church is considered as a property of Christ and its sole purpose is for Praying and Praising the Lord, Jesus Christ. Hence, any Member of the Church voluntarily rescinds his or her membership, he or she will not have any right to demand a reimbursement of any financial or non-financial donation he or she made to the Church during the tenure of his or her Membership.

13.2 EMPLOYEES TO SERVE THE CHURCH

13.2.1 Would be employees will complete employment forms prepared by the Parish Council.

13.2.2 The agreement will be signed by the employee and the Parish Council/the Designated Person of the Church

13.2.3 If for some reason, the employee plan to terminate his service, should give in writing his intentions, three month notice prior to leaving the service.

13.2.4 If there is a misconduct on the part of the employee, the case will be studied by the Inspections Committee and the Parish Council and presented to the General Assembly by the Parish Council

13.2.5 If the employee disagrees with what was presented, can appeal to the General Membership Assembly, who will give a final decision.

13.3 PARISH COUNCIL ADVISORY COMMITTEE

The Parish Council will nominate a three-Member Committee to advise it on matters of the Church's Well-being and its Development, etc. The Advisory Committee will carry out its duties without being involved in day to day activities and administrative matters.

ARTICLE FOURTEEN: AMENDMENT AND IMPLEMENTATION

14.1 AMENDMENTS

14.1.1 The matter of amending these by-laws may be discussed by the Registered Members at least once in two years. If the motion is approved by two-thirds (2/3) of the Registered Members present, the motion will be carried out.

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14.1.2 The meeting to discuss the motion to amend the by-laws will be conducted only if two-thirds (2/3) of all eligible Registered Members are present.

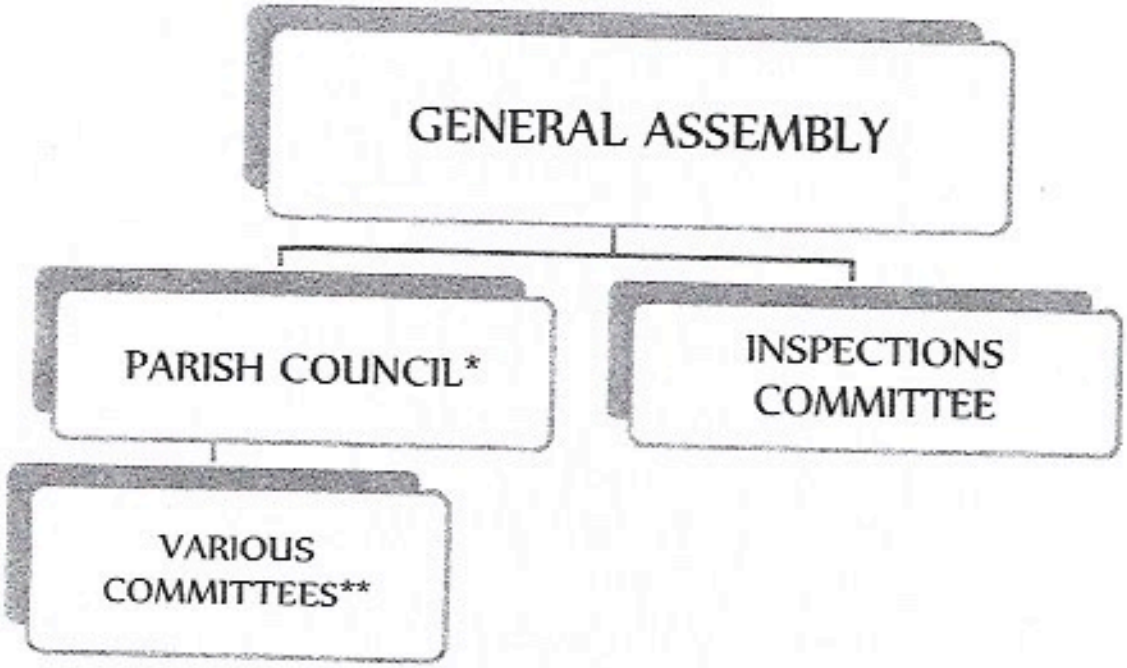
14.1.3 Once the motion to amend the by-laws is agreed upon, the Parish Members will elect a three-member committee to amend the by-laws. The committee will be accountable directly to the Parish Members.

14.2 IMPLEMENTATION

14.2.1 Any amended by-laws will be implemented only after they have been approved by a majority of the Registered Members and have been signed into place by the Parish Council in place at the time of the ratification by this by-law.

14. 2.2 The by-law was implemented on August 14, 2011 in Piedmont Triad and the surrounding areas in North Carolina.

FRAMEWORK (STRUCTURE)



* The priest is a member of the Parish Council

**The type and number of committees will be determined by the Parish Council and their Commmittees will be accountable to the Parish Council.

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Debre Mehret Medhane Alem E.O.T.C. Piedmont, NC